



City Of Medford
Massachusetts

_____2026

PUBLIC PARTICIPATION PETITION

To The Honorable City Council:

The undersigned respectfully request for:

(Please write brief request below)

to read in a memo responsive to certain slanderous, defamatory, and factually untrue statements made by Mayor Lungo-Koehn about myself that were published in the Tufts Daily.

Petitioner's Name: Micah-Shalom Kesselman **Date:** 10/07/2026

Petitioner's Signature: /Micah-Shalom Kesselman/

Residence: ██████████

Place of Business (if applicable): _____

Home/Cell Phone: ██████████

Business Phone: ██████████

Some of you may have read an article in the Tufts Daily, published on September 30th, about the city's legal spending that included some seriously defamatory and outrageous statements from the current Medford Mayor about myself. They have since updated the article with some lines from a rebuttal letter I sent them after the fact, but I am publicly sharing a full version of the letter because it is important to me that the people I work and live with have a complete understanding of everything that transpired here and can trust me and feel safe around me as we continue to fight for a better world and a better Medford.

I want to be very clear--almost every single thing that Breanna Lungo-Koehn stated in regards to myself in the Tufts Daily article was either inaccurate or a complete falsehood, and the incredibly defamatory and dangerous nature of her public statements cannot be understated. As is typical in responding to the increasingly ubiquitous gish gallop tactic in politics these days, it will take a bit of effort to break down Breanna's defamatory statements--certainly more time than it took for her to fabricate them. I will proceed through them in the order in which they were stated.

BREANNA CLAIMED THAT I OFFERED TO REPRESENT THE CITY PRO BONO

I never held myself out to the City to perform any pro bono work related to its defense in the Chertok/Jokelson lawsuit. I am an advanced software and intellectual property attorney, not a municipal law attorney or even a litigator, nor do I have the time or energy to deal with what would clearly be an exceptionally hostile client. When I eventually did enter the case in a professional pro bono capacity, it was on behalf of the Intervenors and was done out of necessity to enable the robust defense that the attorneys at the American-Arab Anti-Discrimination Committee have been providing to the case and the city without cost. They thankfully understood the dire repercussions the case could have not just on Medford but the entirety of the Commonwealth, and so decided to take up representation of the Intervenors after discussions with me.

BREANNA SPELLED MY NAME WRONG

My last name is Kesselman, not "Kessleman." This is minor, maybe even a little petty, but I think it's a bit rude to not know the last name of the person you are defaming.

I AM FROM MEDFORD, NOT ANY PARTICULAR ACTIVIST GROUP

I am not "from OR," as Breanna stated. I rally and work with a litany of municipal groups in Medford--because the current situation of the city, largely due to historic incompetence from the

executive branch leadership, is so catastrophic that it has largely fallen upon residents to take up the necessary work to protect OUR neighbors and help them thrive. I work with Our Revolution Medford (n.b., "OR" or Our Revolution, is almost completely unrelated to ORM, or Our Revolution Medford) when our goals and work align. I also regularly work with Medford for Palestine, LUCE-Medford Hub, Medford People Power, Safe Medford, Medford Community Response Network, many other municipal organizations in the city, and even just my neighbors. You know, because I give a damn about them.

THE MEDFORD CITY COUNCIL DID NOT TURN DOWN ANY OFFER OF PROFESSIONAL SERVICES FROM ME, DUE TO MY CONDUCT OR OTHERWISE

As is overwhelmingly clear by now, the City Council did not "decide[] not to go with" me to represent the city because it was never an option and they never had such authority--as the executive branch of the city has reiterated time and time again.

I HAVE NEVER ADVOCATED OR EXPRESSED INTEREST IN VIOLENCE AGAINST ANY PUBLIC OFFICIAL, ELECTED OR OTHERWISE

Now we come to the especially defamatory and uncalled for nonsense. Earlier this year, Breanna did in fact initiate a clearly politically motivated and spurious police investigation into myself and others with whom I organize. It was ostensibly in regards to a Medford People Power--not Safe Medford, which was completely uninvolved in Breanna's attempted intimidation--meeting. As an aside, and in relation to discussion of whether we should continue to push Breanna to implement a model executive order promulgated by the ACLU to protect local organizers against politically motivated targeting and investigation, I apparently said something along the lines of I am happy to push-push-push the Mayor right towards a cliff, but do not think it's worth spending energy pursuing her support on this one. This is very much a paraphrase because it was such an incidental aside that literally no one at the meeting had any idea what was being referenced when Breanna forced the police to investigate.

The detective's own report, which can be publicly retrieved from the Medford Police Department upon request, makes it very, and nearly explicitly, clear that the entire investigation was baseless and thoroughly politically motivated in relation to a contemplated run for Middlesex's 34th District House Representative seat, which I later bowed out of for completely unrelated reasons. Moreover, even the supposed statement which Breanna instrumentalized to initiate a politically motivated investigation against myself and my colleagues, was nothing like an indication that I wanted to "throw [her] off a cliff." It is atrocious and reprehensible that she would make such allegations in the public press.

I have never advocated for or supported violence against any of our elected officials and would never condone such. Hell, I wouldn't condone it against anyone, regardless of their political position. I can admittedly be less than nice, and might talk like a typical New Englander despite being a transplant, but no one would sincerely accuse me of being unkind or advocating political violence.

When I and my colleagues in Medford People Power were first put through all of this political targeting by Breanna, we decided to largely keep the whole matter to ourselves. We felt we had come out the other side and had too much other important work to do to be distracted or intimidated by what was, at the end of the day, utter nonsense from a petty, flailing individual with an unfortunate amount of power for the time being. Now that it has been raised in the public, and deeply mischaracterized and instrumentalized solely to slander me, it appears we will have to engage in the distraction after all. Regardless of whatever rightful legal action I do or do not take against Breanna as an individual, I think it is important to recognize what this kind of conduct means for the city and its residents as a whole.

THE INCREDIBLY DISTRESSING NATURE OF BREANNA S CONDUCT HERE

This defamatory statement from Breanna is especially troubling because it is indicative of at least two very problematic behaviors that have only escalated in recent months. First, she has always engaged in borderline, at this point I would say well over the border, defamatory and disparaging speech about those who are politically opposed to her--especially if they are vocal and unapologetic. Moreover, she has been more than willing to abuse her position and municipal resources to engage in political bullying and intimidation, as we clearly see here.

The second behavior is far more personal to me, as this comes right off the heels of the City Council meeting of September 29th where it was shared that Breanna had not only refused to utilize city resources to publicize the City Council's ward meetings, which they ordained last year, but actively tried to obstruct those meetings by removing them from the city calendar *merely because I had produced a flyer to publicize the meetings and enable some sort of RSVP*. For whatever reason, it is clear that she has decided to target specifically me and now is doing whatever she can to harm me, personally, professionally, and socially, even if it puts bystanders like my fellow organizers or my family, or even the fundamental democratic systems and axioms of the city itself in danger.

Everything about how Breanna is conducting herself right now is simply untenable, and I sincerely urge her to deeply introspect and work towards a more healthy and reasonable mode of behavior. For her own sake and the sake of the city, if not for mine.